

Variant Rank of MSS Containing Jude (as per Wasserman)¹

Orientation: this study makes no claim to precise accuracy. I simply followed Wasserman, without checking any MSS, except as noted in comment 4 below. I did not count any variant read by over 5% of the MSS, even when both Wasserman and I rejected it;² had I done so, the number of variants for many of the MSS would go up. Wasserman did not register some six types of dittography, which I would certainly include—the number of variants for MSS like 01 and 03 would go up sharply. So, what follows should only be taken as a rough approximation, but is valid and adequate for my present purpose: **to give a statistical demonstration of the mentality of the copyists.**

It is quite obvious that some copyists did not take their task seriously (quite apart from deliberate alteration), while others took it very seriously. Jude is a short book, with only 25 verses. Note that P72, our oldest extant MS, is by far the worst, with two variants per verse! The first 19 MSS listed below are really very poor; the copyists clearly had no respect for what they were copying. The copyists of the next 95 MSS were not taking their work seriously. The quality of their work contrasts sharply with that of the heavy majority of the Family 35 copyists; they evidently understood that they were copying a Sacred Text (**f**³⁵ MSS are underlined).

# of variants	MSS	
51	<u>P⁷²</u>	our oldest extant MS is by far the worst!
34	1241	
32	378, 631, 1838	
30	1646	
29	1847	
28	1751	
25	044	
24	01, 90	
23	1243, 1881	
21	1066, 2147	
20	6, 61, 915, 1505	19 MSS so far
19	38, 629, 1852, 1875, 1886	
18	621, 1729, 2675	
17	88, 322, 323, 1311, 1735, 2495	
16	522, 1611	

¹ Tommy Wasserman, *The Epistle of Jude: Its Text and Transmission*, Stockholm: Almqvist & Wiksell International, 2006.

² As a result, there is very little difference between the eclectic Text and mine. Although I used mine, the point of the exercise is not compromised by that choice.